

Olmsted Falls wraps it up

First Southwestern Conference title in school history

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

AVON LAKE — It isn't often a team can claim a moral victory from a 20-point beating.

But when you're Avon Lake and you're hosting a state-ranked Olmsted Falls team that blew you out by 50 points in the first meeting, a 69-49 loss doesn't seem all that bad.

That was the count in the Bulldogs' eleventh consecutive Southwestern Conference victory Friday night, earning them their first outright SWC title in school history with conference paties Westlake, Bay, and Fairview left on the schedule.

"You can always find something out of a game like this," said Falls' head coach Pat Donahue, whose Bulldogs moved to 15-2 overall and 11-0 in the con-

O.Falls	G	F	T	A.Lake	G	F	T
Tabar	4	2	13	Petty	2	7	7
Matus	3	1	8	Strauch	2	10	8
Newmester	3	3	9	MLora	2	3	8
Steppenacker	4	0	8	Stile	1	0	2
Schaefer	7	0	14	Nelson	1	0	2
Storey	0	1	12	Jocha	0	0	0
Higgins	3	0	4	MkLora	2	0	0
McIn	1	3	0	Waltz	0	0	0
Pedenta	0	0	0	Schaefer	1	1	0
Schneider	1	0	2	King	0	0	2
Kalenba	1	1	3	Burke	1	1	0
Rudjan	0	1	1	Johnson	0	3	3
Totals	27	17	65	Totals	16	15	45
Points by Quarters				1 2 3 4 T			
O.Falls	11	13	4	A.Lake	11	13	4
A.Lake	19	17	20	O.Falls	19	17	20
Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls, Tabar 3, Matus, Avon Lake, Burke 3, Strauch 2, Petty, Matt Lora.							
J.V.: Olmsted Falls 76-64							

ference, playing without mono-stricken starter Jerome Moore. "We tried to emphasize to the kids that this would be a better Avon Lake team than we saw in the first game. I think the score at halftime got their attention."

The Shoremen were able to hang in the first half thanks in

the most part to seniors Matt Lora and Matt Petty, who combined for 14 of their team's 24-point first half total.

After Matt Tabar buried his third three-pointer of the opening quarter to stake the Bulldogs to a 15-4 lead, Avon Lake battled back to close to within seven on a Petty's three-point play with under two minutes left in the half.

What little confidence the Shoremen derived from the first-half performance was dashed by a 19-1 run by Falls to open the third quarter.

Tim Schafer, 6 foot 8, was the catalyst, scoring eight of Olmsted Falls' first 10 points. Schaefer led all scorers on the night with 14 points to go along with his game-high 12 rebounds.

"They didn't miss anything during that run and when they

did they put it back," said A.L. coach Dick Deasy, who saw his Shoremen slip to 4-12 overall and 1-10 in the SWC. "That's (Falls) a good team. They're a tough team for us to deal with."

The Bulldog lead ballooned to 30 at the end of the third quarter on Mike Steppenacker's layup in transition.

Avon Lake, which was out-rebounded 35-22 for the game, trimmed it to 20 midway through the final quarter on one of three fourth-period three-pointers from Ryan Burke. Burke finished with nine points, one behind A.L. leading scorer Rick Strauch.

Both teams have Westlake next on their schedule with Avon Lake facing the Demons Tuesday night, while the Bulldogs take them on Friday.

SWC ROUNDUP

Westlake68
Bay55

BAY VILLAGE — Westlake had 12 people in the scoring column as it downed the Bay Rockets 68-55.

The Demons were led by Kyle Blue and Taysir Yamin with 15 and 10 points, respectively. Westlake improved to 10-7 overall and 6-5 in the Southwestern Conference.

Bay dropped to 3-13 overall and 3-8 in the conference. The Rockets were led by Chad Zebin with 14 points.

Westlake will host Avon Lake on Tuesday, while Bay's next game is against the same Avon Lake five on the road Friday.

Westlake	Bay						
G	F	T	G	F	T		
Guiliano	0	1	Murphy	2	0	4	
Caponi	1	4	Berger	1	0	3	
Collins	1	0	2	Putnam	1	0	2
Westfall	3	0	8	Wihelm	1	0	2
Blue	7	0	15	Musulin	3	0	7
Yamin	4	3	10	Kinsley	1	0	2
Glaizer	3	0	6	Zestudil	2	2	6
Houser	1	5	7	Alexander	1	0	2
Justice	1	0	2	Miler	4	0	11
Armstrong	2	0	8	Zan	6	2	14
Spiller	1	0	2	Glenn	1	0	2
Pull	0	2	2				
Totals 24	15	65	- 23	4	55	-	

North Olmsted.....68
Fairview.....55

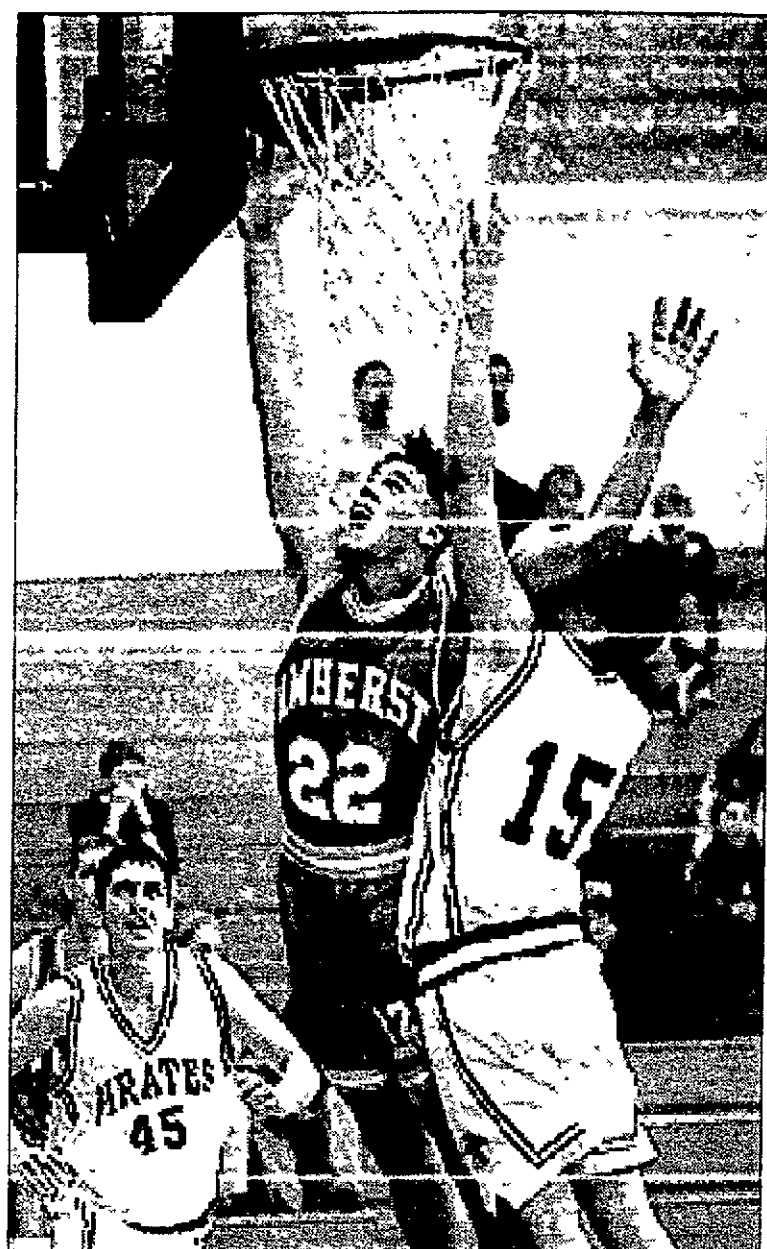
NORTH OLMSTED — Junior Keith Bielozier paced the Eagles with 17 points, which was aided with five 3-pointers for a 68-55 Southwestern Conference win over Fairview Friday night.

Sophomore Mike Busanus led all scorers and had 23 points for the Warriors.

The Eagles evened thier record to 8-8 overall and 5-6 in the conference, while Fairview dropped to 7-9 overall and 4-7 in the league.

North Olmsted travels to Rocky River next Friday and Fairview goes to Amherst.

North Olmsted	Fairview				Fairview		
	G	F	T		G	F	T
Tolbert	3	1	7	Skidmore	2	2	6
Berardo	5	3	13	Busanus	10	1	23
Cerny	2	2	6	Mons	5	0	10
Bielozier	6	0	17	Rosol	4	3	13
Gallagher	1	0	2	Falsolko	1	1	3
Smith	4	1	9				
Sulzer	1	0	2				
Beck	3	1	7				
Totals 27	8	68	22		7	55	-



LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

TWO MORE: Amherst's Todd Damasiewicz (22) scores and draws a foul from Rocky River's Chad Standing (15) in the second quarter Friday.

Amherst defensive lapse is fatal to title hopes

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

ROCKY RIVER — Amherst had two dramatic comebacks to Rocky River's one, but the 10 seconds the Comets were away from overtime proved to be 10 seconds too long.

Amherst knocked them out of any hope for a Southwestern Conference championship as Olmsted Falls' victory against Avon Lake Friday night gave the Bulldogs a four-game lead in the standings with only three left to play.

Tood Damasiewicz had buried a 3-point shot in the left corner to give Amherst a 53-53 tie, but the Comets could not get back on defense in time to stop Sean Kennedy from weaving his way through bodies and feeding Brad Niksa alone under the hoop for the winning layup in a 55-53 Pirate victory.

"It was the same thing at the end of the game as at the beginning," said Comets coach Dave Zvara. "They busted their tails getting down the floor and we walked it down. We were celebrating a 3-pointer and they were hustling to get downcourt."

Kennedy took the inbound pass from J.P. Moran and maneuvered the ball all the way to the foul circle before delivering the pass to Niksa, who laid it in with three seconds showing.

"We got a lot of effort down the stretch," Rocky River coach Jim Rucki said of the fourth quarter

Amherst	G	F	T	R/River	G	F	T
White	4	0	11	Postle	2	2	6
Diedrick	0	0	2	Ostley	3	1	9
Duslo	0	2	2	Standing	3	1	9
Damasiewicz	9	0	21	Moran	1	0	2
Lugar	1	0	2	Kennedy	5	5	12
Roth	5	2	12	CaDolan	2	1	5
Burke	1	1	3	Nikos	4	2	10
Pena	0	0	0	Lichko	2	0	2
				Kent	2	0	4
Totals	20	9	53	Totals	22	6	65
Points by Quarters							
Amherst	1	2	3	4	T		
	14	10	15	10	—	83	
	9	12	14	18	35		
Three-point goals: White 3, Postle 2, Standing 2, Ostley, Damasiewicz,							
Junior varsity: Amherst, 70-36.							

that saw the Pirates rally from nine points behind. "We had a good effort in the first half, but for most of the third quarter we were flat.

"Some guys came off the bench, Chris Oatey and Mike Lichko, and played well. Maybe they were just fresher."

The loss dropped Amherst into a tie for second place in the Southwestern Conference with Rocky River at 7-4. The Comets are 11-5 in all games. The Pirates own a 9-8 overall record.

"They (Rocky River) started and ended the game with more determination than we had," Zvara added. "They outthusted us, penetrated and shot well. We did not shoot well or play good defense."

The Pirates hit 22 of 33 field goal tries (67 percent), including 9 of 10 in the first quarter, but were only 6-of-12 at the foul line. Amherst made 20 of 42 from the field and 9 of 15 at the line. The Comets missed the front end of all three of their one-and-one chances in the closing quarter.

Scott Petrak
Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN— Defense is known to win championships.

Well, it clinched a share of one for Admiral King last night.

Using an extended, aggressive man-to-man defense, the Admirals beat Sandusky 54-47 to improve to 10-0 in the Erie Shore Conference and clinch at least a share of the title.

Admiral King stands 2½ games ahead of Elyria. The Admirals need a win against either Elyria Friday or Southview Feb. 20, or an Elyria loss to win the conference outright. The Pioneers must sweep their last three games and hope for King to fall apart.

The Admirals (13-3 overall) have been without a conference championship since sharing the title in the 1988-89 season. They won the Erie Shore outright in 1987-88.

"I'll tell you what," Admiral King coach John Rositano said.

Sandusky	G	F	T	Admiral King	G	F	T
Hampton	3	0	5	Taylor	4	5	13
Crabb	3	6	12	Hendral	6	4	18
Manuel	1	4	7	Flansom	3	0	7
Redding	2	0	4	Arroyo	1	4	6
Pickens	3	2	8	White	4	1	8
Pougeot	1	0	2	Torrence	1	0	2
J.Jones	1	0	2	Kates	0	2	2
J.Jones	3	0	6				
Totals	17	12	47	Totals	16	15	54
Points by Quarters				1 2 3 4 T			
Sandusky	10 16 7			Admiral King	13 16 7		
Admiral King	13 16 15			Sandusky	10 16 15		
Three-point goals: Sandusky Manuel, Admiral King, Flansom							
JV: Sandusky, 55-49 OT							

"We got a piece and I don't like ties. I want wins and we're going to go for the win on Friday in Elyria."

With a 10-man rotation, the Admirals used fresh legs to hound Sandusky into 27 turnovers. The Blue Streaks were also held to 35 percent shooting.

"Admiral King's defense was really tenacious early," Sandusky coach John Schlesman said. "And we had a hard time getting into our offense."

Leading 29-26 at halftime, the Admirals turned the defensive

AREA BOYS ROUNDUP

Lutheran West rallies past Columbia

COLUMBIA TWP. — Lutheran West outscored Columbia 26-13 in the fourth quarter to rally from a three-point deficit and pull out a 66-56 victory in Metropolitan Area Conference play Friday night.

Jason Kocab led Lutheran West (13-3, 9-2) with 16 points, followed by Phil Argento's 14 — including four 3-pointers.

The Raiders' Barry Morton led all scorers with 18 points, followed by 17 for Mark Skor.

Columbia (6-11, 5-8) hosts Cuyahoga Hts. Tuesday while the Longhorns host Beachwood.

LW	Columbia						
	G	F	T		G	F	T
Williams	4	2	10	Skor	6	4	17
Kocab	6	2	16	Wolf	2	2	7
Argento	5	4	14	Kelly	2	0	4
Pastau	2	2	6	Putzer	4	0	10
Ploegstra	4	1	9	Morton	8	2	18
Fann	4	1	9				
Miller	0	2	2				
Totals	25	10	66	Totals	22	8	55

Berea91
Cloverleaf56

BEREA — Chad James led five scorers in double figures as Berea cruised to a Pioneer Conference victory against Cloverleaf.

The win raised The Braves to 4-12 overall, 3-8 in the conference. James scored 20 points — including four of Berea's nine 3-pointers, followed by Destin Ramsey's 15 points. The Colts were led by Tim Burns with 12.

Clover				Berea			
G	F	T		G	F	T	
Hardy	0	1	1	James	8	8	20
Burns	5	2	12	Carroll	4	0	10
Staffery	1	1	3	Cook	4	2	10
Melrose	2	0	4	Ramsay	7	0	15
Todd	2	0	5	Fredericy	5	0	10
Stalnaker	0	4	4	Cleaver	2	0	5
Wooley	3	1	7	Movall	3	0	6
Pieroli	1	3	5	May	3	0	7
Butler	1	5	7	Speerke	1	0	2
Workman	4	0	8	Lazroff	2	0	4
				Peretz	1	0	2

Willo-Hill50
First Baptist45

WILLOUGHBY — First Baptist was held to three rebounds in the second half, losing to Willo-Hill in a Western Reserve Conference game.

The Sabres (3-5, 7-10) led by seven at halftime but couldn't hold the lead.

Brent Reffner scored 19 points to lead Willo-Hill.

Richard Woodward led First Baptist with 15 points while Kevin Vanderground added 10.

FBaptist	G	F	T	WilloHill	G	F	T
Vance	3	0	7	Wallis	1	2	4
Stedman	2	0	5	Reifner	8	3	19
Vndrigmd	3	4	10	Sopensid	0	1	1
Davis	1	2	5	Weybrecht	2	3	8
Woodward	5	4	15	Benholm	3	4	12
Gish	0	1	1	Booth	2	2	8
Evans	1	0	2				
Totals	15	11	45	Totals	18	15	50